BPP Coursework Cover Sheet

Please use the table below as your cover sheet for the 1st page of the submission. The sheet should be before the cover/title page of your submission.

Programme	
Module name	
Student Reference Number (SRN)	
Report/Assignment Title	
Date of Submission *(Please attach the confirmation of any extension received)*	

Declaration of Original Work:

- I hereby declare that I have read and understood BPP's regulations on plagiarism and that this is my original work, and that I have researched, undertaken, completed and submitted in accordance with the requirements of BPP School of Business.

- I declare that where I have used any AI tools, it was for the following reasons (highlight as appropriate):
  - To review a draft
  - To correct language errors
  - Other (please describe)

  _____

- I have copied & retained for BPP University's reference, all AI prompts used in the creation of AI content and all AI-generated responses in support of my assignment and attached relevant evidence in the appendices.

- I understand that I may be required to participate in a *viva voce,* where I will be questioned on any aspect of my assignment, including key concepts, theories, examples used, & any sources included.

- The word count, excluding contents table, bibliography and appendices, is ___ words.

Student Reference Number: **Date**:

By submitting this coursework you agree to all rules and regulations of BPP regarding assessments and awards for programmes.
Please note, submission is your declaration you are fit to sit.
BPP University reserves the right to use all submitted work for educational purposes and may request that work be published for a wider audience.
BPP School of Business

BPP UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL

MSc Management (All streams)

Principles of Management

Formative Assessment Brief

Submission mode: **Turnitin online access**

1. General Assessment Guidance

- **Please note late submissions will not be marked.**
- You are required to submit all elements of your assessment via **Turnitin online access**. Only submissions made via the specified mode will be accepted and hard copies or any other digital form of submissions (like via email or pen drive etc.) **will not be accepted**.
- For coursework, the submission word limit is 1000 words. You must comply with the word count guidelines. You may submit LESS than 1000 words but not more. Word Count guidelines can be found on your programme home page and the coursework submission page.
- Do not put your name or contact details anywhere on your submission. You should only put your student registration number (SRN) which will ensure your submission is recognised in the marking process.
- You are required to use only Harvard Referencing System in your submission. Any content which is already published by other author(s) and is not referenced will be considered as a case of plagiarism.
- *You can find further information on Harvard Referencing in the online library on the Hub* (Found via Help&Support). *You can use the following link to access this information:* https://bpp.libguides.com/home/business
- BPP University has a strict policy regarding authenticity of assessments. In proven instances of plagiarism or collusion, severe punishment will be imposed on offenders. You are advised to read the rules and regulations regarding plagiarism and collusion in the GARs and MOPP which are available on HUB in the Academic registry section (Found via Help & Support).
- **Use of AI in assessments is only allowed for the purposes of reviewing a draft, correcting language errors or if specified in the summative assessment brief.** If you have used AI for any of these purposes, you should indicate this on the Assignment Cover sheet. For more information regarding acceptable and unacceptable use of AI, please enrol onto the Generative AI Foundations course on the HUB.
- You should include a completed copy of the **Assignment Cover sheet**. Any submission without this completed Assignment Cover sheet may be considered invalid and not marked.

Assessment Brief

For this formative assignment you will produce a 1000-word management report on McDonald's in an academic style.

In this formative assignment, you will cover the following learning outcome (LOs):

LO1 – Apply knowledge and understanding of the key management theories and concepts/practices to contemporary organisations.

Assessment Scenario

Acting as a business consultant, you are required to analyse the management functions and practices and write a business report for the senior management team of McDonalds. You must utilise the techniques and concepts you have covered in the module.

McDonald's Corporations

- **Date Founded: 1940**
- **Industry: Restaurants**
- **Corporate Headquarters: Chicago, Illinois**
- **Type: Public**

McDonald's Corporation is a chain of fast-food restaurants that was headquartered in Oak Brook, Illinois, until corporate operations moved back to Chicago in 2018. It is one of the largest fast-food chains in the world. By the mid-2020s, the company operated over 36,000 restaurants in more than 100 countries, serving, on average, 63 million customers every day. According to the company, franchisees operated 95 percent of its restaurants worldwide at that time, with the other restaurants under the company's direct control.



A Big Mac combo meal with French fries and Coca-Cola. Toddst2 at English Wikipedia [CC BY-SA 3.0 (creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0) or GFDL (www.gnu.org/copyleft/fdl.html)], via Wikimedia Commons



McDonald's sign. By JKCarl (Own work) [CC BY-SA 3.0 (creativecommons.org/licenses/by-sa/3.0)], via Wikimedia Commons

McDonald's was founded in 1940 by two brothers, Richard "Dick" and Maurice "Mac" McDonald, and it was later taken over by businessman Ray Kroc, who turned it into a chain and popularized the franchising concept.

The company's primary menu item is the hamburger, but McDonald's has adapted its menus in different countries to cater to local tastes. McDonald's is also famous for its French fries, children's meals (called Happy Meals), chicken, fish, and breakfast items.

The McDonald's logo consists of the iconic golden arches, which form an M. The logo originally came about before the age of mass media. The golden arches were built into the building's exterior in order to announce the restaurant's presence to potential customers. By the late 1960s, as other avenues for advertising grew, the arches took on a life of their own as a symbol of the company.

History

The first McDonald's restaurant, called McDonald's Bar-B-Q, opened in 1940 in San Bernardino, California. Brothers Dick and Mac McDonald ran a drive-in restaurant with a sizeable menu. In 1948, they changed to a self-service drive-in model with a much more limited menu, the principal item being the fifteen-cent hamburger. In 1954, Ray Kroc, who sold Multi-mixers (for making milkshakes) for a living, investigated why McDonald's was buying large numbers of Multi-mixers. Impressed by the business model and the brothers' dedication to efficiency and quality, Kroc convinced the two men to let him start a chain of franchises across the country. A few years later, he bought the trademarks, copyrights, recipes, and rights to the McDonald's name.

Kroc touted four principles—quality, service, cleanliness, and value—that had to be adopted by the chain's many franchisees. This system's approach meant that a McDonald's burger in one part of the country would taste exactly the same as a burger in a completely different region. These principles have remained a part of McDonald's business philosophy for more than half a century. By 1963, the company had sold over one billion burgers, and by 1993 the number had exceeded one hundred billion.

One reason for the company's global success over time has been its ability to cater to varying tastes and dietary requirements in different countries. For example, McDonald's stores in France have traditionally served wine, and in India, McDonald's does not use beef because a large portion of the country's population is Hindu.

In late 2014, in response to declining profits in the previous few years, McDonald's announced plans to restructure its organization in the United States to better cater to customers' preferences in

different regions. In early 2015, Steve Easterbrook, a British executive, stepped in as McDonald's new CEO. Partially as a result of the criticism that the company has faced over time regarding the lack of nutritional value in its food, Easterbrook was determined to transform McDonald's to meet modern dietary trends for high-quality and nutritious foods. Shortly after Easterbrook started at McDonald's, and in response to the growing concern that people were developing resistance to antibiotics due to their widespread use in poultry and livestock, the company announced that it would begin serving chicken that had not been raised with such medicines.

In 2019, the company embraced technology to improve service and labor costs with the implementation of digital kiosks for ordering and partnered with UberEats to expand its ability to deliver food to customers. Additionally, McDonald's began to see an increase in sales related to the 2018 decision to switch to using fresh beef quarter-pound burgers instead of frozen. Similarly, the company announced in 2018 that it was removing artificial ingredients from all the burgers offered, which also extended to the buns and sauces used. In an effort to compete with fast-food chains such as Popeye's, McDonald's had also begun testing a premium chicken sandwich by the end of 2019.

Despite its flexible approach to changing consumer preferences, McDonald's faced multiple setbacks in the early 2020s. In early 2020, the company began to feel the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic, which had spread globally by March of that year and led to lockdowns and restaurant closures in many countries, along with a global recession. The company's profits declined 68 percent in the second quarter of June 2020 compared to the same period in 2019.

Early in 2022, McDonald's joined a number of international chains, including Starbucks, when it decided to close all of its restaurants in Russia following the country's invasion of Ukraine in February of that year. The company had operated in Russia since it opened its first restaurant in Moscow in January 1990 and had roughly 850 locations and 65,000 employees in the country by 2022. The move, which the company said was prompted by humanitarian concerns in the wake of the invasion, cost McDonald's an estimated $1.2 billion in losses as it withdrew from one of its most significant European markets and sold its restaurants to a local owner, who later rebranded and reopened most of the former McDonald's locations.

Despite the loss of its Russian operations, McDonald's continued to expand in subsequent years, with the mid-2020s marked by significant growth.

Impact

McDonald's has originated a variety of iconic menu items over the years. The most classic is the Big Mac, a triple-decker hamburger with lettuce, onions, American cheese, pickles, and sauce, which was invented by Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania, franchisee Jim Delligatti in the early 1960s. It made its way onto the national McDonald's menu in 1968, and it is now seen as representing American capitalism. There is even an economic scale called the Big Mac Index, inspired by the sandwich, that was designed to determine how currencies are valued.

In 1962, franchisee Lou Groen invented the Filet-O-Fish in Cincinnati, Ohio, in response to his difficulty selling hamburgers on Fridays to his primarily Catholic customers. Shortly after the federal government published guidelines about cholesterol intake, chicken entered the McDonald's menu in the early 1980s. The company was concerned that customers would start avoiding beef and was eager to meet their demand with a leaner option. Eventually, 40 percent of McDonald's sales would come from classic items such as the Big Mac and the Chicken McNugget. Another product, the McRib sandwich, was originally introduced on the menu in 1981, but it was removed in 1985 due to

weak sales. However, it has acquired a cultlike following among some consumers and is often added to the menu seasonally in many of the chain's restaurants.

McDonald's invested in Chipotle Mexican Grill in 1998, when Chipotle had thirteen stores. McDonald's eventually came to own over 90 percent of Chipotle and helped it grow to over five hundred stores before divesting its stake in 2006.

McDonald's engages in philanthropic work. It is the largest corporate partner of the Ronald McDonald House Charities, a nonprofit organization that provides services such as housing near hospitals for families with very ill children, rooms in hospitals for families to rest and regroup, scholarships for children in need, and mobile health care clinics for children. By the mid-2020s, there were over 380 Ronald McDonald Houses, more than 265 Family Room programs, and roughly 40 Care Mobile programs worldwide.

All McDonald's managers and franchise owners are required to complete a weeklong program at the company's Hamburger University. Hundreds of thousands of people have completed this highly selective program, earning degrees in Hamburgerology. Hamburger University includes modules on customer service and how to run a business, and credits earned there can be used toward a college degree. The school has campuses at McDonald's Illinois headquarters and also overseas.

McDonald's has faced controversy in several realms over the years. In 2003, documentary filmmaker Morgan Spurlock did an experiment during which he ate nothing but McDonald's food for a month, which he documented in his film *Super Size Me* . During this time, he gained eighteen pounds and suffered severe liver damage, although the results of this experiment, along with Spurlock's methods, later came under scrutiny. Still, the film helped raise awareness about the obesity epidemic in the United States and how McDonald's and other fast-food chains could be contributing to the problem.

Furthermore, McDonald's has faced criticism for underpaying its restaurant workers. In late 2012, workers started pushing for higher pay, and in early 2015 the company promised to raise wages for workers at company-owned stores by $1. However, workers argued that this was not enough, and protesters outside the 2015 McDonald's shareholders' meeting demanded a $15-per-hour wage. McDonald's maintains that it has no control over wages at franchised stores. In early 2019, the company announced that it was ending its efforts to lobby against the fight to increase the minimum wage. The company also made attempts to offer workers other benefits; for example, in 2024, McDonald's announced plans to partner with colleges to establish ways for employees to earn college credits through their work that would count toward degrees in hospitality, culinary arts, and other fields.

Through philanthropy and controversy, McDonald's remained one of the most globally recognized brands throughout the twenty-first century and continued seeking ways to innovate its restaurants using the latest technology.

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To access the above information:

Mahtani, S.M. (2025) 'McDonald's Corporation', Salem Press Encyclopedia [Preprint]. Available at: https://research.ebsco.com/linkprocessor/plink?id=5a3be69a-9d84-3b9b-b7a6-1ccda84ff33e (Accessed: 10 February 2026).

Official company website:

https://corporate.mcdonalds.com/corpmcd/home.html

https://www.mcdonalds.com/gb/en-gb.html

It is recommended that you should carry out a substantial amount of independent and individual research to strengthen your understanding of the business context and the preferred style of management practice.

Assessment Tasks

You are to critically analyse and evaluate the current management practices at McDonald's.

Task 1 – Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices (LO1)

For McDonald's, discuss how management theories, concepts and practices are currently adding value. Explain, with evidence, what these management practices have contributed to the success of McDonald's.

Support your arguments with reference to appropriate academic literature, case study materials and your independent research.

Assessment Guidelines

Introduction:

- Introduce McDonald's and explain the context of your management report.
- Briefly discuss the current issues at McDonald's.

Task 1 – Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices (LO1)

- Explain how management is contributing to success/adding value.
- Briefly discuss the four philosophies of the Competing Values Framework and apply the most appropriate dimension to AstraZeneca's management approach supported by examples. Additionally, apply one other relevant management theory that is influencing the management practices at McDonald's.
- The relevant management theory must be appropriate to your answer. You may choose to consider the following theories: Scientific Management Theory, Bureaucratic Theory, Administrative Theory, Contingency Theory, TQM Theory etc. ***NOTE: Students are not limited to the theories given in this list and are expected to research others and choose the most appropriate theory. DO NOT attempt to apply all theories.***

Presentation and Referencing

Your work should include a range of references reflecting appropriate academic literature, case study materials and your independent research presented in accordance with the Harvard Reference System.

Report Structure

Your report structure should include the following sections:

- Cover page (BPP University Administration Cover Sheet)
- Table of Contents
- List of Abbreviations (if appropriate)
- **Introduction** (Optional) (100)
- **Task 1** (900)
- References
- Appendices (if required)

Word count: 1000 words

*Word count – only applies to the main body (shown in bold); i.e., cover page, table of contents, list of abbreviations, references and appendix **are not** part of the 1000-word count.*

If you have any further questions about this coursework assignment, please contact the module leader or your tutor.

Academic Skills, Structure and References

- Work demonstrates intellectual originality, integrity, coherence, creativity and imagination.
- Professional academic standards are followed consistently.
- Structure is in line with the given instructions.
- Tasks 1 must be written in 3rd person, using an academic style.
- Give a professional appearance with consistent formatting.
- Spellings and grammar are correct.
- Each page has page number in the Footer.
- Any tables or figures are correctly labelled.
- Tables and figures do not cross boundaries, unless necessary
- Properly cite your sources in the text and in the list of references
- Use Harvard style for referencing and in text citations (see referencing guides and https://bpp.libguides.com/Home/StudySupport)

2. Marking Guide

Criterion	0-39%	40-49%	50-59%	60-69%	70-79%	80-100%
	Fail	**Marginal Fail**	**Pass**	**Merit**	**Distinction**	**High Distinction**
LO1 – Apply knowledge and understanding of the key management theories and concepts/practices to contemporary organisations	**Inadequate, weak or no** explanation of Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices. The discussion is weak and lacks evidence from academic literature to support the arguments or claims made. Inadequate or no use of sources, and there may be gaps in providing relevant citations or references.	**Limited** explanation of Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices. The discussion has limited evidence from academic literature to support the arguments or claims made. The use of sources might be inconsistent, and there may be gaps in providing relevant citations or references.	**Satisfactory** explanation of Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices. The discussion has satisfactory evidence from academic literature to support the arguments or claims made. The analysis demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and incorporates relevant citations to support arguments and claims. The sources used are appropriate and contribute to the overall credibility of the report.	**Good** explanation of Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices. The discussion is well-supported by evidence from academic literature. The analysis demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and effectively integrates relevant citations and references throughout. The sources used are varied and demonstrate a breadth of research.	**Excellent** explanation, showcasing in-depth understanding and knowledge into Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices. The discussion is strong with well-structured arguments that is convincing and well-supported by a wide range of sources and/or evidence. Explores the boundaries of existing knowledge. Evidence of extensive reading and use of sources/material in support of the work.	**Outstanding** explanation and comprehensive understanding and knowledge of Key Management Theories, Concepts and Practices, displaying exceptional insight and depth. Answer goes beyond the boundaries of existing knowledge. Outstanding evidence of original, independent and critical thought. Evidence of extensive reading and perfect use of sources/material in support of the work that provides a report worthy of publication.